

1 Think of songs or genres of music you could describe using these adjectives.

- 1 If a song is **catchy**, you quickly want to sing it and can't stop.
- 2 If music is **repetitive**, it has the same boom boom beat all the way through.
- 3 If a song is **heavy**, it's very loud and has a strong beat.
- 4 If a song is **soft**, it's quiet and relaxing to listen to.
- 5 If we say the music or lyrics (the words to the song) are **sentimental**, they are romantic or sad in a bad way.
- 6 If we say a song is very **commercial**, it is a negative way of saying it is written to sell a lot.
- 7 If music or songs are **moving**, they make you cry.
- 8 If music is **bland**, it's boring.
- 9 If music is **uplifting**, it makes you happy or hopeful.
- 10 If music is **depressing**, it makes you sad.



THE PLAYLIST
OF YOUR LIFE

2 Complete the conversations with the pairs of adjectives in the box.

- 1 A: Do you mind if we don't listen to this song? I find it really It kind of reminds me of when my dad died.
B: Sure, no problem, I'll put on something more
- 2 A: Oh, turn the radio off. That DJ is so boring. He just plays this music the whole time.
B: Well, they need to play stuff sometimes. They need to make money.
- 3 A: I love the lyrics of this song. They're so and romantic.
B: Don't tell me you're going to cry. I can't believe you like this rubbish.
- 4 A: Please stop humming that tune to yourself. You're driving me mad.
B: Sorry, but it's just so And the beat is so, I can't get it out of my head.
- 5 A: Are you into rock music?
B: No, it doesn't do much for me. It's a bit I like something and relaxing - a nice bit of Vivaldi or Debussy.

catchy / repetitive
bland / commercial
depressing / uplifting
heavy / soft
moving / sentimental

3 Put the conversation into the correct order.

- ___ a Erm, I don't know ... Girls Rock, Soul Train, **stuff like that**.
- ___ b **All sorts really, but mainly** pop music and R&B.
- ___ c Oh right. **Anyone in particular?**
- ___ d Yeah, all the time.
- ___ e So **have you heard anything good** recently?
- ___ f **What kind of music are you into?**
- ___ g Do you **listen to music much?**
- ___ h Well, I downloaded this great song by K Boy. It's fantastic.

**TALKING
ABOUT
TASTES**

We often move from asking about general tastes to more specific tastes.
There are common questions we ask when talking about **music**, **films** and **books**.

4 Circle the correct words to complete the conversation.

- A: Do you watch films ¹*much / lot*?
- B: Yeah, all the time.
- A: What ²*like / kind* of films are you into?
- B: ³*All / Every* sorts really, but ⁴*hardly / mainly* science fiction and adventure movies.
- A: Oh right. Any films ⁵*of / in* particular?
- B: I don't know ... *Blade Runner, The Matrix* series, ⁶*stuffs / stuff* like that.
- A: So have you seen ⁷*anything / any good* recently?
- B: Well, I saw this old black and white movie from the 1950s called *Invasion of the Body Snatchers*.

5 Work in pairs. Look at the song titles and artists below. Do you know any of them? Do you like them?

- | | |
|---------------------------------|--|
| • Hey Jude (The Beatles) | • I Wanna Be Like You (from The Jungle Book) |
| • Stuck Me (The Gimmies) | • Take My Hand (Ivan & The Parazol) |
| • Starships (Nicki Minaj) | • My Heart Will Go On (Céline Dion) |
| • The Four Seasons (Vivaldi) | • Gangnam Style (Psy) |
| • Limón Y Sal (Julieta Venegas) | |

6 Read the article and find out if the readers like the songs in Exercise 5 or not – and why.

For generations, music lovers have made collections of songs to soundtrack their lives. Nowadays, technology makes it easier than ever to create, find and share playlists to suit every mood and occasion. We set our readers 'a playlist challenge'. Here is their response.



THAT WAS A GREAT YEAR PLAYLIST

Starships by Nicki Minaj reminds me of 2012, which I spent studying in Amsterdam. There were loads of other foreigners studying there and we became very close. We all worked hard, but we partied hard as well. Whenever this song came on at a party or club, we all jumped up and danced – it didn't matter how tired we were. There's a great video that goes with it too. I sometimes watch it online. [Corina, Germany]

MUSIC WHEN I'M DOWN PLAYLIST

I've put Vivaldi's The Four Seasons, but I actually only play two seasons! The winter section is sad and moving and that sometimes matches my mood, but then I play the spring section because it's so uplifting. I'd actually like it played at my funeral! There was life before me, there will be life after me, like spring that comes again after winter. Julieta Venegas' Limón Y Sal also cheers me up. My husband bought it for me. The lyrics basically say 'I love you however you are; you don't have to change anything.' [Kari, Chile]



ALL-TIME CLASSICS PLAYLIST

The top of any all-time classic list has to be Hey Jude by the Beatles. It's a song you immediately want to sing along to. The Beatles are the reason why I learnt English. Stuck Me is by The Gimmies, a Japanese band. I've seen them live and they were loud and energetic – incredible. [Toshi, Japan]

MUSIC FOR MY WORST ENEMY PLAYLIST

This was difficult to choose. I hate that Céline Dion song that was used in the film Titanic – My Heart Will Go On. I can't stand commercial pop music – it's so sentimental. However, the worst is Gangnam Style by Psy. It reminds me of family weddings and people doing the stupid dance. The problem is it's so catchy! The other day I heard it as the ringtone on a mobile phone and I couldn't get it out of my head all morning! It was really annoying. [Kevin, Scotland]



MY FAMILY PLAYLIST

My dad's a big jazz fan and always has music on in the background. Personally, jazz doesn't do anything for me. I just find it strange. However, he used to play one song for me – I Wanna Be Like You from the film The Jungle Book. Now we play it to my younger brother and it always makes him laugh. Take my Hand is for my sister. We both love indie music and it's by a relatively new Hungarian band called Ivan & The Parazol that we've been listening to a lot recently. They're going to be big. [Natalia, Hungary]



7 Read the article again. Which person / people in the article:

- 1 likes different kinds of music to their father?
- 2 finds some songs drive them mad?
- 3 has good memories of time spent abroad?

- 4 went to a concert by one of their favourite bands?
- 5 predicts that one band will become famous?
- 6 mention special ceremonies?

8 Correct the words in *italics* with words from the article. Then work in pairs. Discuss if any of the sentences are true for you.

- 1 There's a song I dance to whenever it *puts* on in a club.
- 2 If I'm sad, I like to play something sad to *same* my mood.
- 3 I love singing *together* to songs. I like karaoke.
- 4 I've seen lots of bands *lively*.
- 5 I don't like *sensitive* songs about love and romance.
- 6 There's a song which really *remembers* me of my father.
- 7 I sometimes *make* stupid dances to some songs.
- 8 I like to study with music on in the *behind*.
- 9 Classical music doesn't *feel* anything for me. It's bland.

9 Answer the questions.

- 1 What is the song Starship associated with?
- 2 How did Corina spend time in Amsterdam?
- 3 How is the difference between The Winter and The Spring?
- 4 Why does Limon Y Sal cheer Kari up?
- 5 What does Toshi want to do when he hears Hey Jude?

- 6 How did the Gimmies sound?
- 7 What can't Kevin stand?
- 8 Why does he hate Gangnam Style?
- 9 What is Natalia's opinion about jazz?
- 10 What kind of music does she like?

10 Choose two playlist titles from below and make a list of three songs you want to include.

- My current favourites
- Music I can't stand
- Music for a romantic evening
- That reminds me of ...
- Music to fall asleep to
- I can't get it out of my head
- Party music

11 Say as much as you can about the songs you have chosen. Use new words.